

1 ENGROSSED SENATE  
2 CONCURRENT  
3 RESOLUTION NO. 17  
4 By: Boren and McIntosh of the  
5 Senate  
6  
7 and  
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9 Hill and Stewart of the  
10 House  
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13 A Concurrent Resolution recognizing the long  
14 friendship between Oklahoma and Ireland;  
15 commemorating economic relations between Ireland and  
16 Oklahoma; welcoming esteemed guests from Ireland;  
17 recognizing ties between Ireland and the United  
18 States and the Irish ancestry of many Oklahomans;  
19 commemorating the celebration of St. Patrick's Day  
20 throughout the state; and directing distribution.  
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25 WHEREAS, Oklahoma and Ireland have enjoyed a long friendship  
26 that predates Oklahoma's statehood and Ireland's independence; and  
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28 WHEREAS, in 1847, during the Irish famine, the Choctaw Nation  
29 raised \$170.00 for famine relief, over \$5,000.00 in today's money,  
30 which was a fortune at the time, even though they had recently been  
31 forcibly been moved to Oklahoma on the Trail of Tears; and  
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33 WHEREAS, in 2017, Ireland commemorated the gift of the Choctaw  
34 Nation with the dedication of the Kindred Spirits sculpture,  
35 featuring a circle of eagle feathers, in County Cork; and  
36  
37 WHEREAS, the Choctaw Nation unveiled on August 30, 2024, as a  
38 tribute to their connection with Ireland, the Eternal Heart  
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1 sculpture, depicting a Celtic Trinity knot intertwined with a heart,  
2 facing the east toward Ireland; and

3 WHEREAS, in 2024, Oklahoma established the Oklahoma Ireland  
4 Trade Commission for Oklahoma businesses and industries to benefit  
5 from Ireland's position within the European trade market; and

6 WHEREAS, the Oklahoma State Legislature is honored to welcome  
7 Senator Aubrey McCarthy, of the Irish Senate, and Mr. Phil Thompson,  
8 Chief Executive Officer of the humanitarian organization Tiglin, an  
9 Irish organization dedicated to helping people overcome addiction,  
10 homelessness, and social exclusion, which he co-founded alongside  
11 Senator McCarthy in 2008. The two will meet with Oklahoma business  
12 leaders regarding economic development opportunities between  
13 Oklahoma and Ireland. Their visit also honors the 250th anniversary  
14 of the adoption of the Declaration of Independence on July 4, 1776.  
15 Three of the signatories were born in Ireland, and others were of  
16 Irish descent; and

17 WHEREAS, many Oklahomans take pride in their Irish ancestry and  
18 continue to preserve Irish culture through festivals and  
19 celebrations, particularly in March, as Oklahomans honor the Patron  
20 Saint of Ireland and celebrate Irish heritage, including Tulsa  
21 IrishFest, ShamROCK the Gardens in Oklahoma City, and the Oklahoma  
22 City St. Patrick's Parade in Stockyards City, with Margaret "Peg"  
23 Malloy serving as this year's Grand Marshal.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION  
OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES  
CONCURRING THERIN:

THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature recognizes the state's long history of friendship and relationships with Ireland.

THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature welcomes Senator Aubrey McCarthy and Phil Thompson as they visit the Great State of Oklahoma.

THAT the Oklahoma State Legislature commemorates March 17 as St. Patrick's Day.

THAT a copy of this resolution be distributed to Senator Mark Daly, Chair of the Senate of Ireland; and the Oklahoma American Irish State Legislators Caucus.

Adopted by the Senate the 11th day of March, 2026.

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Presiding Officer of the Senate

Adopted by the House of Representatives the \_\_\_\_ day of \_\_\_\_\_,  
2026.

Presiding Officer of the House  
of Representatives